CDL General Knowledge Test Questions and Answers

113 practice questions with answers and explanations, grouped by topic

Written from the Commercial Driver's License Manual (Version 07/20/2026 (form DMV 60A), AAMVA, Virginia DMV edition). Each answer names the manual section it comes from.

Take this test online with instant explanations:

https://cdl-testprep.com/cdl-practice-test/general-knowledge/

How to use this PDF: answer the questions in Part 1 first, then check yourself with the answer key in Part 2.

Passing score on each CDL knowledge test: at least 80% correct (49 CFR 383.135).

These are our own practice questions, not the questions on the real test. CDL Test Prep is an independent study site and is not affiliated with any DMV, state agency or the FMCSA.

Part 1: Questions

Vehicle inspection (10 questions)

1. When should you do an after-trip inspection?

- **A.** Only when you noticed a defect during the trip
- **B.** Once a week, on the same day
- **C.** Only before a state inspection
- **D.** At the end of the trip, day, or tour of duty on each vehicle you drove

2. While testing the service brakes at about 5 mph, the vehicle pulls to one side when you brake firmly. What can this mean?

- **A.** The ABS is working normally
- **B.** The tires are overinflated
- **C.** The parking brake is still set
- **D.** Brake trouble

3. Which tires are prohibited on the front wheels of a bus?

- **A.** Tires with more than 4/32 inch of tread
- **B.** Tires of the same size on both sides
- **C.** Tires with valve caps in place
- **D.** Re-grooved, recapped, or retreaded tires

4. How much tread depth do you need in every major groove on a front tire?

- **A.** 1/32 inch
- **B.** 2/32 inch
- **C.** 4/32 inch
- **D.** 6/32 inch

5. **You test hydraulic brakes for leaks by pumping the pedal three times, then holding firm pressure for five seconds. What result shows no problem?**
   - **A.** The pedal slowly sinks toward the floor
   - **B.** The pedal pushes back up against your foot
   - **C.** The brake warning light comes on
   - **D.** The pedal does not move

6. **What share of missing leaves in a leaf spring will put a vehicle out of service?**
   - **A.** One-tenth or more
   - **B.** One-fourth or more
   - **C.** One-half or more
   - **D.** All of them

7. **After you start the engine, how soon should oil pressure come up to normal?**
   - **A.** Within seconds
   - **B.** Within 3 minutes
   - **C.** After 10 minutes of idling
   - **D.** Only after the vehicle starts moving

8. **How do you check that the parking brake holds?**
   - **A.** Set it, put the vehicle in a low gear and gently pull forward against it
   - **B.** Pump the brake pedal three times and hold it
   - **C.** Drive at about 5 mph and push the brake pedal firmly
   - **D.** Release it on a downhill slope and see how far you roll

9. **During an inspection you see rust around the wheel nuts. What might this mean?**
   - **A.** The nuts may be loose
   - **B.** The tire is underinflated
   - **C.** The brakes are overheating
   - **D.** The wheel bearing needs oil

10. **Steering wheel play of more than how much can make a vehicle hard to steer?**
    - **A.** 5 degrees
    - **B.** 10 degrees
    - **C.** 20 degrees
    - **D.** 45 degrees

Basic control and shifting (8 questions)

11. **Why would you select a low range on an automatic transmission?**
    - **A.** To save fuel on the highway
    - **B.** To make the transmission shift up sooner
    - **C.** To make starting on ice easier
    - **D.** To get more engine braking on downgrades

12. **When you must back and turn, which way does the manual recommend turning?**
    - **A.** Toward the driver's side
    - **B.** Toward the right side
    - **C.** Whichever side has less traffic
    - **D.** Never turn; only back in a straight line

13. Which gear should you use when backing?

- **A.** The highest reverse gear
- **B.** Neutral, letting the vehicle roll
- **C.** Whichever reverse gear keeps the engine quiet
- **D.** The lowest reverse gear

14. When should you downshift for a curve?

- **A.** Before entering the curve
- **B.** In the middle of the curve
- **C.** As you leave the curve
- **D.** Only when the curve goes downhill

15. Before starting down a hill, which gear should you usually be in?

- **A.** The highest gear the engine can pull
- **B.** Neutral, to let the vehicle coast
- **C.** One gear higher than you would need to climb the hill
- **D.** A gear lower than you would need to climb the same hill

16. When should you turn the retarder off?

- **A.** Whenever the road is wet, icy, or snow covered
- **B.** When going down a long grade
- **C.** When the vehicle is fully loaded
- **D.** Whenever you drive faster than 40 mph

17. When a retarder is on, which wheels does it slow?

- **A.** All wheels
- **B.** The steering wheels only
- **C.** The trailer wheels only
- **D.** The drive wheels only

18. While speeding up on a snowy road, your drive wheels begin to spin. What should you do?

- **A.** Take your foot off the accelerator
- **B.** Press the accelerator harder
- **C.** Brake firmly
- **D.** Shift quickly to a higher gear

Seeing and communicating (11 questions)

19. When turning, when should you cancel your turn signal?

- **A.** Not until you have completed the turn
- **B.** As soon as you start the turn
- **C.** Halfway through the turn
- **D.** Before you enter the intersection

20. How should you hold reflective triangles while setting them out?

- **A.** Between yourself and oncoming traffic
- **B.** Behind your back
- **C.** Above your head
- **D.** On the side away from traffic

21. Compared with looking at them directly, how do things look in a convex (curved) mirror?

- **A.** Larger and closer than they really are
- **B.** Exactly the same size and distance
- **C.** Smaller and farther away than they really are
- **D.** Larger and farther away than they really are

22. A driver behind you wants to pass. What does the manual say about signaling to them that it is safe to pass?

- **A.** Do it only on straight roads
- **B.** You should not do it
- **C.** Do it with your right turn signal
- **D.** Do it only in daylight

23. During a lane change, why check your mirrors again after you have signaled?

- **A.** To check that your turn signal is flashing
- **B.** To see whether the vehicle ahead is braking
- **C.** To check that your cargo is secure
- **D.** To check that no one has moved into your blind spot

24. At dawn, at dusk or in rain, which lights help other drivers see you?

- **A.** Identification and clearance lights only
- **B.** Headlights on low beam
- **C.** Headlights on high beam
- **D.** Four-way flashers only

25. On the open highway, looking 12 to 15 seconds ahead means looking about how far ahead?

- **A.** About one block
- **B.** About a quarter of a mile
- **C.** About 100 feet
- **D.** About two miles

26. When can mirror adjustment be checked accurately?

- **A.** When the trailer or trailers are straight
- **B.** While turning
- **C.** While backing
- **D.** Only at night

27. You are about to pass a bicyclist at night. When it is legal, how can you let them know you are there?

- **A.** Sound the horn for several seconds
- **B.** Turn on your four-way flashers
- **C.** Flash your lights from low to high beam and back
- **D.** Pull alongside and slow down

28. If you stop on the shoulder of a road, how soon must you put out your emergency warning devices?

- **A.** Within 30 minutes
- **B.** Within one hour
- **C.** Within ten minutes
- **D.** Only if it is dark

29. You stop on a two-lane road with traffic in both directions. Where do the warning devices go?

- **A.** 10 feet, 100 feet and 200 feet behind the vehicle
- **B.** 50 feet behind and 50 feet ahead
- **C.** One device, 500 feet behind the vehicle
- **D.** Within 10 feet of a front or rear corner, plus 100 feet behind and 100 feet ahead

Speed and space management (18 questions)

30. The temperature is below freezing and the road ahead looks wet. What should you watch out for?

- **A.** Bleeding tar
- **B.** Black ice
- **C.** Fresh oil from the first rain
- **D.** Loose gravel

31. As the temperature drops, which usually freezes first?

- **A.** Bridges
- **B.** The road surface next to them
- **C.** Both at exactly the same time
- **D.** Neither, until it is well below zero

32. What have tests shown about trucks with a high center of gravity on curves?

- **A.** They can roll over at the posted speed limit for the curve
- **B.** They are safe at any speed below the posted limit
- **C.** They roll over only on wet roads
- **D.** They are less likely to roll over than cars

33. You fit under a bridge with a loaded van. Later the van is empty. What should you know?

- **A.** The empty van sits lower, so it will fit
- **B.** The empty van sits higher, so it may not fit
- **C.** Load does not change a van's height
- **D.** You can always rely on the earlier trip

34. You drive a 50-foot vehicle at 30 mph. How many seconds of following distance does the manual's rule call for?

- **A.** 3 seconds
- **B.** 5 seconds
- **C.** 6 seconds
- **D.** 10 seconds

35. Under the manual's following-distance rule, what changes when you drive faster than 40 mph?

- **A.** Double the following distance
- **B.** Subtract 1 second
- **C.** Nothing changes
- **D.** Add 1 second

36. In heavy traffic, what is the safest speed?

- **A.** About 10 mph below the speed of traffic
- **B.** The speed of other vehicles
- **C.** As fast as needed to pass slower vehicles
- **D.** Faster than traffic, to stay clear of other vehicles

37. Your vehicle starts to hydroplane. How can you regain control?

- **A.** Brake hard
- **B.** Speed up to get through the water
- **C.** Release the accelerator and push in the clutch
- **D.** Turn the steering wheel sharply

38. If there is a lot of water on the road, hydroplaning can happen at speeds as low as:

- **A.** 10 mph
- **B.** 30 mph
- **C.** 50 mph
- **D.** 70 mph

39. Why shouldn't you trust the height posted at a bridge or overpass?

- **A.** Posted heights are always measured in meters
- **B.** Posted heights include a 2-foot safety margin
- **C.** Re-paving or packed snow may have reduced the clearance
- **D.** Heights are posted only for cars

40. When is a road especially slippery during rain?

- **A.** After several hours of steady rain
- **B.** Only at night
- **C.** Only on bridges
- **D.** Right after the rain begins

41. Your vehicle cannot make a right turn without swinging into another lane. What should you do?

- **A.** Swing wide to the left before starting the turn
- **B.** Back up to make more room
- **C.** Start the turn from the left lane
- **D.** Turn wide as you complete the turn, keeping the rear close to the curb

42. In ideal conditions at 55 mph, what is the minimum total stopping distance, counting perception, reaction and braking distance?

- **A.** 142 feet
- **B.** 216 feet
- **C.** 419 feet
- **D.** 1,000 feet

43. Someone is tailgating you. What does the manual advise about your speed?

- **A.** Don't speed up; being tailgated is safer at a low speed
- **B.** Speed up to get away from them
- **C.** Flash your brake lights to warn them
- **D.** Brake suddenly so they back off

44. Compared with 20 mph, how much greater are impact and braking distance at 60 mph?

- **A.** 3 times
- **B.** 6 times
- **C.** 9 times
- **D.** 12 times

45. There are two left-turn lanes. Which one should you use?

- **A.** The right-hand turn lane
- **B.** The left-hand (inside) turn lane
- **C.** Whichever has less traffic
- **D.** Either, as long as you signal early

46. On a wet road, by about how much should you reduce your speed?

- **A.** About one-tenth
- **B.** About one-half or more
- **C.** To a crawl
- **D.** About one-third

47. What is the number one cause of injury and death in roadway work zones?

- **A.** Poor lighting
- **B.** Uneven road surfaces
- **C.** Speeding traffic
- **D.** Construction equipment

Hazards and distracted driving (9 questions)

48. Compared with hand-held phones, how likely are hands-free devices to distract you?

- **A.** They never distract you
- **B.** They distract you only in heavy traffic
- **C.** They are half as likely to distract you
- **D.** They are no less likely to distract you

49. Which of these is listed as a clue that a driver may be impaired?

- **A.** Driving exactly at the speed limit
- **B.** Signaling well before turning
- **C.** Keeping a long following distance
- **D.** Driving with an open window in cold weather

50. A CDL holder is convicted a second time within 3 years for using a hand-held phone while driving a CMV. How long is the disqualification?

- **A.** 30 days
- **B.** 60 days
- **C.** 120 days
- **D.** 1 year

51. What does the manual say about speed limits posted on off ramps and on ramps?

- **A.** They are set for trucks, so they are always safe
- **B.** They may be safe for cars but not for large or heavily loaded vehicles
- **C.** They apply only to cars
- **D.** They can be exceeded by 5 mph in dry weather

52. What does the slow moving vehicle symbol look like?

- **A.** A yellow diamond with a black arrow
- **B.** A white rectangle with black letters
- **C.** A red triangle with an orange center
- **D.** A round black-on-yellow sign

53. Why should you be careful near a stopped bus?

- **A.** Buses always pull out without signaling
- **B.** Passengers may cross in front of or behind it and often can't see you
- **C.** Stopped buses may roll backward
- **D.** Bus drivers often open the doors into traffic

54. Under the federal rule for CMV drivers, which of these counts as texting?

- **A.** Talking to a passenger
- **B.** Listening to the radio
- **C.** Reading a text message on a phone
- **D.** Checking the mirrors

55. How much greater are the odds of a safety-critical event for CMV drivers who text while driving than for those who don't?

- **A.** 2 times
- **B.** 6 times
- **C.** 23.2 times
- **D.** 100 times

56. Which are clues that a driver may be a tourist who is unfamiliar with the area?

- **A.** Car-top luggage and out-of-state license plates
- **B.** A clean car and new tires
- **C.** A long following distance
- **D.** Headlights on during the day

Night, fog and weather (12 questions)

57. In very hot weather, why watch for spots where tar rises to the road surface?

- **A.** They are very slippery
- **B.** They can puncture tires
- **C.** They show the road is about to crack
- **D.** They mark where to stop

58. On long trips, how often does the manual suggest taking a break?

- **A.** About every 300 miles or 5 hours
- **B.** About every 100 miles or 2 hours
- **C.** Only when you start to feel sleepy
- **D.** Once per day

59. Within what distance of an oncoming vehicle should you dim your headlights?

- **A.** 100 feet
- **B.** 250 feet
- **C.** 500 feet
- **D.** 1,000 feet

60. You notice signs of fatigue while driving. What does the manual tell you to do?

- **A.** Stop driving and sleep for the night or take a short nap
- **B.** Open the window and keep going
- **C.** Drink coffee and push on
- **D.** Drive faster to finish sooner

61. What is the best advice for driving in fog?

- **A.** Use high beams to see farther
- **B.** Speed up to get through it quickly
- **C.** Follow the taillights ahead closely
- **D.** Don't; wait at a rest area or truck stop until visibility improves

62. If you must drive in fog, which lights give the best visibility?

- **A.** Low-beam headlights and fog lights
- **B.** High-beam headlights
- **C.** Parking lights only
- **D.** No lights during daytime

63. In very hot weather, how often should you inspect your tires?

- **A.** Once a day
- **B.** Every 30 minutes
- **C.** Every two hours or every 100 miles
- **D.** Only before the trip

64. About how far ahead can you see with low beams?

- **A.** 100 feet
- **B.** 250 feet
- **C.** 500 feet
- **D.** 1,000 feet

65. In winter, you notice there is no spray coming off other vehicles' tires. What does this tell you?

- **A.** The road is dry and safe
- **B.** Ice has formed on the road
- **C.** Other drivers have chains on
- **D.** The temperature is rising

66. The engine has cooled and your hands are protected. How do you start removing the radiator cap to add coolant?

- **A.** Remove it quickly in one turn
- **B.** Tap it with a tool until it loosens
- **C.** Push down hard and turn it all the way at once
- **D.** Turn it slowly to the first stop to release the pressure seal

67. What can happen if the radiator shutters freeze shut or the winterfront is closed too much?

- **A.** The heater will blow cold air
- **B.** The engine may overheat and stop
- **C.** The brakes will lock
- **D.** The fuel will gel

68. Why should you avoid dark or tinted corrective lenses at night?

- **A.** They make headlights look brighter
- **B.** They are illegal in every state
- **C.** They cut down the light you need to see clearly
- **D.** They fog up in cold weather

Railroad crossings and mountain driving (9 questions)

69. On a long downgrade, why do brakes that are out of adjustment matter?

- **A.** They stop doing their share first, so the other brakes can overheat and fade
- **B.** They do more than their share of the work
- **C.** They only affect parking
- **D.** They make the engine braking weaker

70. What happens when brakes begin to fade from overheating?

- **A.** They grab harder than normal
- **B.** They work better once they are hot
- **C.** You must press them harder and harder for the same stopping power
- **D.** They stop the vehicle with less pedal pressure

71. When is the braking effect of the engine greatest?

- **A.** At idle in a high gear
- **B.** In neutral
- **C.** At low rpm in the top gear
- **D.** Near the governed rpm with the transmission in a lower gear

72. What does the advance warning sign before a public railroad crossing look like?

- **A.** Diamond-shaped, black on orange
- **B.** Eight-sided, white on red
- **C.** Triangular, red and white
- **D.** Round, black on yellow

73. At a crossing with two tracks, a train has just passed. What should you keep in mind?

- **A.** Trains never use both tracks at once
- **B.** A train on one track may hide a train on the other
- **C.** The gates always stay down for a second train
- **D.** You may cross as soon as the first train clears

74. What should you avoid doing while crossing railroad tracks?

- **A.** Looking both ways
- **B.** Keeping a steady speed
- **C.** Shifting gears
- **D.** Keeping both hands on the wheel

75. There is no white stop line at a railroad crossing. A vehicle that must stop there should stop how far from the nearest rail?

- **A.** 5 to 10 feet
- **B.** 15 to 50 feet
- **C.** 50 to 100 feet
- **D.** At least 100 feet

76. Your vehicle gets stuck on railroad tracks. What should you do first?

- **A.** Get out of the vehicle and away from the tracks
- **B.** Stay in the cab and keep trying to move
- **C.** Set out triangles on the tracks
- **D.** Wait in the cab for the train crew

77. On a long downgrade your safe speed is 45 mph. Using the manual's braking technique, at about what speed do you release the brakes?

- **A.** 30 mph
- **B.** 35 mph
- **C.** 40 mph
- **D.** 45 mph

Emergencies, ABS and skids (12 questions)

78. Your ABS stops working. What does that mean for braking?

- **A.** You still have regular brakes; drive normally and get it serviced soon
- **B.** You have no brakes and must stop at once
- **C.** You must brake only with the parking brake
- **D.** You must pump the brakes at all times

79. Truck tractors with air brakes must have ABS if they were built on or after:

- **A.** March 1, 1997
- **B.** March 1, 1998
- **C.** March 1, 1999
- **D.** March 1, 2001

80. What is controlled braking?

- **A.** Braking fully and releasing when the wheels lock
- **B.** Braking as hard as you can without locking the wheels
- **C.** Pumping the pedal as fast as possible
- **D.** Using only the parking brake

81. What is the first step to correct a drive-wheel braking skid?

- **A.** Brake harder
- **B.** Accelerate
- **C.** Stop braking
- **D.** Shift to a lower gear

82. In a front-wheel skid, what is the only way to stop the skid?

- **A.** Turn the steering wheel more sharply
- **B.** Accelerate
- **C.** Pump the brakes hard
- **D.** Let the vehicle slow down

83. If your steering suddenly feels heavy, what is it probably a sign of?

- **A.** A failed rear tire
- **B.** Wet brakes
- **C.** A retarder that is switched on
- **D.** A failed front tire

84. In an emergency you drive off the road onto the shoulder. When should you start braking?

- **A.** Right away and as hard as possible
- **B.** Only after you are back on the pavement
- **C.** When your speed has dropped to about 50 mph
- **D.** When your speed has dropped to about 20 mph, then gently

85. An oncoming driver has drifted into your lane. Which way is usually best to move?

- **A.** To your left, into the other lane
- **B.** Straight ahead while braking hard
- **C.** To your right
- **D.** Stop in your lane and sound the horn

86. You must return to the road from the shoulder before stopping. When do you counter-steer?

- **A.** When both front tires are on the paved surface
- **B.** Before the front tires leave the shoulder
- **C.** When only the rear tires are on the pavement
- **D.** After driving 100 feet on the road

87. What causes most serious skids?

- **A.** Worn brake linings
- **B.** Driving too fast for road conditions
- **C.** Strong crosswinds
- **D.** Underinflated tires

88. With stab braking, how long can it take for the wheels to start rolling after you release the brakes?

- **A.** Up to five seconds
- **B.** Up to ten seconds
- **C.** Up to one second
- **D.** They start rolling instantly

89. Compared with stopping, how quickly can you usually turn to miss an obstacle?

- **A.** Always more slowly
- **B.** Almost always more quickly
- **C.** About the same
- **D.** Only more quickly when empty

Accidents, fires and alcohol (14 questions)

90. What is the first thing to do at an accident scene?

- **A.** Keep another accident from happening in the same spot
- **B.** Move the injured into your vehicle
- **C.** Take photos of the damage
- **D.** Exchange insurance details

91. As blood alcohol builds up, which part of the brain is affected first?

- **A.** The part that controls breathing
- **B.** The part that controls judgment and self-control
- **C.** The part that controls hearing
- **D.** The part that controls long-term memory

92. There is a cargo fire in a van trailer. What should you do with the doors?

- **A.** Keep them shut
- **B.** Open them to let the smoke out
- **C.** Open them to reach the fire
- **D.** Open only the side door

93. You have an engine fire. What does the manual say about the hood?

- **A.** Open it fully to reach the fire
- **B.** Open it a little to let smoke out
- **C.** Remove it before using the extinguisher
- **D.** Don't open it if you can avoid it

94. Where should you aim a fire extinguisher?

- **A.** Up into the flames
- **B.** At the source or base of the fire
- **C.** At the smoke
- **D.** Above the fire

95. Your vehicle is on fire. Where should you stop?

- **A.** At the nearest service station
- **B.** Next to a building, so help is close
- **C.** In the travel lane, so others can see you
- **D.** In an open area away from buildings, trees, brush and other vehicles

96. When do you need the hazardous materials endorsement to drive a vehicle carrying hazardous materials?

- **A.** Whenever any hazardous material is on board
- **B.** Only for loads over 10,000 pounds
- **C.** Only on interstate trips
- **D.** When the vehicle requires placards

97. How does the manual say to stop heavy bleeding?

- **A.** Raise the person's feet
- **B.** Apply direct pressure to the wound
- **C.** Pour cold water on the wound
- **D.** Move the person to a warm place

98. When should you move a severely injured person?

- **A.** Always, to get them off the road
- **B.** Whenever they ask to be moved
- **C.** Only if fire or passing traffic makes it necessary
- **D.** Only after giving them water

99. How many identical placards must a placarded vehicle have?

- **A.** At least one
- **B.** At least two
- **C.** At least four
- **D.** At least six

100. When may a driver on duty use a drug a doctor has prescribed?

- **A.** Never
- **B.** Only on trips under 100 miles
- **C.** When the doctor says it will not affect safe driving ability
- **D.** Whenever it was bought legally

101. Which drink contains the same amount of alcohol as a 12-ounce glass of 5% beer?

- **A.** A 5-ounce glass of 12% wine
- **B.** A 12-ounce glass of 12% wine
- **C.** Two shots of 80 proof liquor
- **D.** Two 12-ounce glasses of 5% beer

102. While you are driving, where may hazardous materials shipping papers be kept?

- **A.** In a pouch on the driver's door or in clear view within reach
- **B.** Locked in the cargo area
- **C.** In a toolbox under the trailer
- **D.** At the motor carrier's office

103. Why should you not use water on a gasoline fire?

- **A.** It can cause an electric shock
- **B.** It works too slowly
- **C.** It will spread the flames
- **D.** It damages the engine

Cargo safety (10 questions)

104. Under a bridge formula, axles that are closer together are allowed:

- **A.** Less maximum axle weight
- **B.** More maximum axle weight
- **C.** The same weight as any other axles
- **D.** No weight limit on state roads

105. Why check your cargo covers in the mirrors while driving?

- **A.** A flapping cover can tear loose and block your view or someone else's
- **B.** To see whether the cover is the right color
- **C.** Because covers must be replaced every trip
- **D.** To check that the cover is wet

106. After starting a trip, within how many miles should you inspect the cargo and its securing devices again?

- **A.** 10 miles
- **B.** 25 miles
- **C.** 50 miles
- **D.** 150 miles

107. What can too little weight on the driving axles cause?

- **A.** Hard steering
- **B.** Brake fade
- **C.** Overheated tires
- **D.** Poor traction

108. What is the Gross Vehicle Weight Rating (GVWR)?

- **A.** The weight shown on a scale at the moment of weighing
- **B.** The weight carried by one axle
- **C.** The most weight a tire can carry
- **D.** The loaded weight of a single vehicle as specified by the manufacturer

109. Why does hanging meat in a refrigerated truck call for extra care on sharp curves and ramps?

- **A.** It is heavier than other cargo
- **B.** It can spoil if you drive slowly
- **C.** It can be a very unstable load with a high center of gravity
- **D.** It must be tied down every 5 feet

110. What does a front-end header board protect you from?

- **A.** Wind and rain
- **B.** Your cargo moving forward in a crash or emergency stop
- **C.** Low bridges
- **D.** Sun glare

111. How should you load cargo to keep the center of gravity low?

- **A.** Put the heaviest parts on top
- **B.** Put all the weight over the rear axle
- **C.** Put the heaviest parts under the lightest parts
- **D.** Stack the cargo as high as possible

112. When hauling less than a full load of livestock, what should you use?

- **A.** Tie-downs on each animal
- **B.** False bulkheads to keep the animals bunched together
- **C.** A tarp over the trailer
- **D.** Extra weight on the front axle

113. Federal rules require the aggregate working load limit of a cargo securement system to be at least what share of the cargo's weight?

- **A.** One-quarter
- **B.** One-half
- **C.** Equal to the weight
- **D.** Twice the weight

Part 2: Answer key

Each answer has a short explanation in our own words and the CDL manual section it comes from. Reread that section for every question you missed.

Vehicle inspection

1. **D. At the end of the trip, day, or tour of duty on each vehicle you drove**
   Each vehicle you operated gets an after-trip inspection when the trip, day or tour of duty ends. A written report may list any problems.
   Manual section 2.1.2 Types of Vehicle Inspection

2. **D. Brake trouble**
   Pulling to either side during the stopping test is a sign that something may be wrong with the brakes.
   Manual section 2.1.5 Seven-step Inspection Method

3. **D. Re-grooved, recapped, or retreaded tires**
   A bus may not run re-grooved, recapped or retreaded tires on its front wheels.
   Manual section 2.1.3 What to Look For

4. **C. 4/32 inch**
   Front tires need at least 4/32 inch of tread in each major groove. The lower 2/32 inch minimum is for the other tires.
   Manual section 2.1.3 What to Look For

5. **D. The pedal does not move**
   A pedal that stays put under steady pressure passes the test. If it moves, there may be a leak, so get it fixed before driving.
   Manual section 2.1.5 Seven-step Inspection Method

6. **B. One-fourth or more**
   Losing a quarter or more of the leaves puts the vehicle out of service, although any leaf spring defect can be dangerous.
   Manual section 2.1.3 What to Look For

7. **A. Within seconds**
   Oil pressure should reach its normal range a few seconds after start-up. If it does not, something is wrong.
   Manual section 2.1.5 Seven-step Inspection Method

8. **A. Set it, put the vehicle in a low gear and gently pull forward against it**
   With the parking brake set and a low gear selected, a gentle pull forward shows whether the brake keeps the vehicle from moving.
   Manual section 2.1.5 Seven-step Inspection Method

9. **A. The nuts may be loose**
   Rust streaks around wheel nuts can be a sign of looseness, so check how tight they are.
   Manual section 2.1.3 What to Look For

10. **B. 10 degrees**
    More than 10 degrees of free play, about 2 inches at the rim of a 20-inch wheel, is a steering defect to look for.
    Manual section 2.1.3 What to Look For

Basic control and shifting

11. D. To get more engine braking on downgrades

A low range keeps the transmission from shifting up, which gives you more engine braking on the way down a grade.

Manual section 2.3.3 Automatic Transmissions

12. A. Toward the driver's side

Backing toward the driver's side lets you watch the rear of the vehicle through the side window. Backing toward the right is much harder to see.

Manual section 2.2.4 Backing Safely

13. D. The lowest reverse gear

Backing slowly in the lowest reverse gear makes steering errors easier to correct and lets you stop quickly.

Manual section 2.2.4 Backing Safely

14. A. Before entering the curve

Slowing and choosing the right gear before the curve lets you use some power through it, which keeps the vehicle more stable.

Manual section 2.3.1 Manual Transmissions

15. D. A gear lower than you would need to climb the same hill

Shift down before the downgrade, usually below the climbing gear, so you can control speed without hard braking.

Manual section 2.3.1 Manual Transmissions

16. A. Whenever the road is wet, icy, or snow covered

On a slippery road a retarder can make the drive wheels skid, so switch it off in rain, ice or snow.

Manual section 2.3.4 Retarders

17. D. The drive wheels only

A retarder brakes only the drive wheels, and it works whenever you fully release the accelerator.

Manual section 2.3.4 Retarders

18. A. Take your foot off the accelerator

Spinning drive wheels mean too much power for the traction you have. Easing off the accelerator lets them grip again.

Manual section 2.2.1 Accelerating

Seeing and communicating

19. A. Not until you have completed the turn

Keep signaling through the whole turn so others know what you are doing, then turn it off once the turn is done.

Manual section 2.5.1 Signal Your Intentions

20. A. Between yourself and oncoming traffic

Carrying the triangles on the traffic side helps approaching drivers see you while you walk.

Manual section 2.5.2 Communicating Your Presence

21. C. Smaller and farther away than they really are

Convex mirrors show a wider area, but objects in them look smaller and more distant, so allow for that.

Manual section 2.4.2 Seeing to the Sides and Rear

22. B. You should not do it

Waving other drivers on could cause a crash, and you could be blamed for it. Let them decide for themselves.

Manual section 2.5.1 Signal Your Intentions

23. **D. To check that no one has moved into your blind spot**
Someone may move into your blind spot after you signal, so check again before moving over.
Manual section 2.4.2 Seeing to the Sides and Rear

24. **B. Headlights on low beam**
When visibility is poor, turn on the headlights themselves and keep them on low beam, since high beams bother other drivers.
Manual section 2.5.2 Communicating Your Presence

25. **B. About a quarter of a mile**
At highway speed, 12 to 15 seconds of travel covers roughly a quarter mile. At lower speeds it is about one block.
Manual section 2.4.1 Seeing Ahead

26. **A. When the trailer or trailers are straight**
Check mirror adjustment before each trip with the trailer straight behind you, otherwise the view is misleading.
Manual section 2.4.2 Seeing to the Sides and Rear

27. **C. Flash your lights from low to high beam and back**
Assume the person does not see you. A quick change from low to high beam and back can alert them at night.
Manual section 2.5.2 Communicating Your Presence

28. **C. Within ten minutes**
Warning devices must be set out within 10 minutes of stopping on a road or shoulder, day or night.
Manual section 2.5.2 Communicating Your Presence

29. **D. Within 10 feet of a front or rear corner, plus 100 feet behind and 100 feet ahead**
On an undivided road traffic comes from both sides, so one device marks the vehicle and the others go 100 feet away in each direction.
Manual section 2.5.2 Communicating Your Presence

Speed and space management

30. **B. Black ice**
Black ice is thin and clear, so the road just looks wet. Below freezing, a wet-looking road is a warning sign.
Manual section 2.6.2 Matching Speed to the Road Surface

31. **A. Bridges**
Bridges ice over before the rest of the road, so take extra care near 32 degrees Fahrenheit.
Manual section 2.6.2 Matching Speed to the Road Surface

32. **A. They can roll over at the posted speed limit for the curve**
A posted curve speed is not always safe for a top-heavy truck, so slow down before the curve.
Manual section 2.6.3 Speed and Curves

33. **B. The empty van sits higher, so it may not fit**
Removing the load lets the van ride higher, so clearing a bridge loaded does not prove you can clear it empty.
Manual section 2.7.4 Space Overhead

34. **B. 5 seconds**
Below 40 mph the rule is one second for every 10 feet of vehicle length, so a 50-foot vehicle needs 5 seconds.
Manual section 2.7.1 Space Ahead

35. **D. Add 1 second**
Above 40 mph, take the one-second-per-10-feet figure and add one more second.
Manual section 2.7.1 Space Ahead

36. **B. The speed of other vehicles**
Vehicles moving in the same direction at the same speed rarely hit each other, as long as that speed is legal and safe.
Manual section 2.6.5 Speed and Traffic Flow

37. **C. Release the accelerator and push in the clutch**
Easing off the accelerator and pushing in the clutch slows the vehicle and lets the wheels turn freely. Do not brake.
Manual section 2.6.2 Matching Speed to the Road Surface

38. **B. 30 mph**
With enough standing water, tires can lose contact with the road even at about 30 mph, especially with low pressure or worn tread.
Manual section 2.6.2 Matching Speed to the Road Surface

39. **C. Re-paving or packed snow may have reduced the clearance**
The road surface can rise after a sign is posted, for example from new pavement or packed snow, so real clearance may be lower.
Manual section 2.7.4 Space Overhead

40. **D. Right after the rain begins**
Fresh rain mixes with oil left on the pavement, which makes the surface very slippery until the rain washes it away.
Manual section 2.6.2 Matching Speed to the Road Surface

41. **D. Turn wide as you complete the turn, keeping the rear close to the curb**
Keeping the rear near the curb and going wide at the end stops other drivers from passing on your right.
Manual section 2.7.6 Space for Turns

42. **C. 419 feet**
Perception, reaction and braking distance together add up to at least 419 feet at 55 mph on dry pavement.
Manual section 2.6.1 Stopping Distance

43. **A. Don't speed up; being tailgated is safer at a low speed**
Speeding up only makes a crash worse. Keep a low, steady speed and give yourself more room ahead.
Manual section 2.7.2 Space Behind

44. **C. 9 times**
Tripling your speed makes both the striking power and the braking distance nine times greater.
Manual section 2.6.1 Stopping Distance

45. **A. The right-hand turn lane**
Starting from the inside lane may force you to swing right during the turn. The right-hand lane avoids that.
Manual section 2.7.6 Space for Turns

46. **D. About one-third**
Slow by roughly a third on wet pavement, for example from 55 to about 35 mph. Packed snow and ice call for even more.
Manual section 2.6.2 Matching Speed to the Road Surface

47. **C. Speeding traffic**
Speed is the leading danger in work zones. Obey posted limits and slow down more when workers are near the road.
Manual section 2.6.7 Roadway Work Zones

Hazards and distracted driving

48. **D. They are no less likely to distract you**
Your attention leaves the road with either kind of phone, so hands-free does not remove the distraction.
Manual section 2.9.4 Cell/Mobile Phones

49. **D. Driving with an open window in cold weather**
Among the signs of a sleepy, drunk, drugged or ill driver are weaving, stopping at the wrong time, and a window left open in the cold.
Manual section 2.8.3 Drivers Who Are Hazards

50. **B. 60 days**
A second conviction within 3 years brings a 60-day disqualification. Three or more within 3 years bring 120 days.
Manual section 2.9.4 Cell/Mobile Phones

51. **B. They may be safe for cars but not for large or heavily loaded vehicles**
Ramp speed signs are often set with cars in mind. A big or heavy vehicle may need to go slower, especially on downhill curves.
Manual section 2.8.2 Hazardous Roads

52. **C. A red triangle with an orange center**
Farm, construction and other slow machines may carry this red-bordered orange triangle. Seeing it early helps avoid a crash.
Manual section 2.8.3 Drivers Who Are Hazards

53. **B. Passengers may cross in front of or behind it and often can't see you**
People getting off a bus may walk around it into your path without seeing your vehicle.
Manual section 2.8.3 Drivers Who Are Hazards

54. **C. Reading a text message on a phone**
Texting covers typing text into an electronic device and also reading text from one.
Manual section 2.9.5 Texting

55. **C. 23.2 times**
Research cited in the manual puts the risk at 23.2 times greater for texting drivers. Dialing a phone raises it 6 times.
Manual section 2.9.5 Texting

56. **A. Car-top luggage and out-of-state license plates**
Visitors who do not know the roads may turn or stop suddenly. Luggage on the roof and plates from another state can give them away.
Manual section 2.8.3 Drivers Who Are Hazards

Night, fog and weather

57. **A. They are very slippery**
Tar that bleeds up through hot pavement makes a slick surface.
Manual section 2.14.2 Driving

58. **B. About every 100 miles or 2 hours**
Regular breaks on long trips, roughly every 2 hours or 100 miles, help you stay alert.
Manual section 2.11.2 Driver Factors

59. **C. 500 feet**
Switch to low beams when an oncoming vehicle is within 500 feet, and also when you follow another vehicle that closely.
Manual section 2.11.5 Night Driving Procedures

60. **A. Stop driving and sleep for the night or take a short nap**
Pushing on when tired is a major cause of fatal crashes. Sleep, or at least a 15 to 20 minute nap, is the answer.
Manual section 2.11.2 Driver Factors

61. **D. Don't; wait at a rest area or truck stop until visibility improves**
If you can, pull off the road and wait. If you must drive, slow down before entering the fog.
Manual section 2.12 Driving in Fog

62. **A. Low-beam headlights and fog lights**
Low beams and fog lights work best in fog, even in daytime. Turning on the 4-way flashers also helps drivers behind you.
Manual section 2.12 Driving in Fog

63. **C. Every two hours or every 100 miles**
Heat raises tire pressure and temperature, so check the tires every 2 hours or 100 miles.
Manual section 2.14.1 Vehicle Checks

64. **B. 250 feet**
Low beams light up roughly 250 feet of road and high beams about 350 to 500 feet, so slow down enough to stop within that range.
Manual section 2.11.4 Vehicle Factors

65. **B. Ice has formed on the road**
When tires stop throwing up spray on a winter road, the water has likely frozen.
Manual section 2.13.2 Driving

66. **D. Turn it slowly to the first stop to release the pressure seal**
Turning to the first stop lets the pressure escape while you step back. Only then press down and remove the cap.
Manual section 2.14.1 Vehicle Checks

67. **B. The engine may overheat and stop**
Blocking too much airflow to the radiator can make the engine overheat, even in winter.
Manual section 2.13.1 Vehicle Checks

68. **C. They cut down the light you need to see clearly**
Even if they seem to reduce glare, tinted lenses block light that you need for night driving.
Manual section 2.11.2 Driver Factors

Railroad crossings and mountain driving

69. **A. They stop doing their share first, so the other brakes can overheat and fade**
Every brake must carry its part of the load. Poorly adjusted brakes leave the work to the others, which then overheat.
Manual section 2.16.3 Brake Fading or Failure

70. **C. You must press them harder and harder for the same stopping power**
Hot brakes lose effectiveness. If you keep using them hard, they can fade until you cannot slow down at all.
Manual section 2.16 Mountain Driving

71. **D. Near the governed rpm with the transmission in a lower gear**
Engine braking is your main speed control on downgrades, and it works best at high rpm in a low gear.
Manual section 2.16.1 Select a "Safe" Speed

72. **D. Round, black on yellow**
The round yellow sign with black markings tells you to slow down, look and listen, and be ready to stop.
Manual section 2.15.2 Warning Signs and Devices

73. B. A train on one track may hide a train on the other

One train can block your view of a second one, so make sure no other train is near before you start across.

Manual section 2.15.3 Driving Procedures

74. C. Shifting gears

Stay in one gear on the tracks. Make sure before you start that you can get all the way across.

Manual section 2.15.5 Crossing the Tracks

75. B. 15 to 50 feet

Without a painted stop line, stop at least 15 feet but no more than 50 feet from the nearest rail.

Manual section 2.15.2 Warning Signs and Devices

76. A. Get out of the vehicle and away from the tracks

Get yourself to safety first. Then use the emergency number posted at the crossing and give its location.

Manual section 2.15.6 Special Situations

77. C. 40 mph

Brake firmly when you reach the safe speed, release at about 5 mph below it, then repeat when you are back at the safe speed.

Manual section 2.16.4 Proper Braking Technique

Emergencies, ABS and skids

78. A. You still have regular brakes; drive normally and get it serviced soon

ABS is added to the normal brakes. If it fails, the normal brakes still work, but have the system repaired soon.

Manual section 2.18.7 Braking If ABS Is Not Working

79. A. March 1, 1997

The requirement started with air-braked truck tractors in 1997, other air-braked vehicles in 1998, and heavier hydraulic-braked trucks and buses in 1999.

Manual section 2.18.2 Vehicles Required to Have Antilock Braking Systems

80. B. Braking as hard as you can without locking the wheels

Controlled braking keeps the wheels rolling while you brake hard, with only small steering moves.

Manual section 2.17.2 How to Stop Quickly and Safely

81. C. Stop braking

Releasing the brakes lets the rear wheels roll again so they stop sliding. Then counter-steer as the vehicle straightens.

Manual section 2.19.2 Correcting a Drive-wheel Braking Skid

82. D. Let the vehicle slow down

In a front-wheel skid the vehicle keeps going straight however you steer. Ease off the turning and braking and let it slow.

Manual section 2.19.3 Front-wheel Skids

83. D. A failed front tire

Heavy steering usually points to a front tire failure. A rear tire failure may cause fishtailing instead.

Manual section 2.17.4 Tire Failure

84. D. When your speed has dropped to about 20 mph, then gently

Braking hard on a loose surface can cause a skid. Wait until you have slowed to about 20 mph, then brake very gently.

Manual section 2.17.1 Steering to Avoid a Crash

85. **C. To your right**
If the other driver notices the mistake, they will likely return to their own lane, so moving right avoids meeting them there.
Manual section 2.17.1 Steering to Avoid a Crash

86. **A. When both front tires are on the paved surface**
Turn back sharply onto the road, then counter-steer as soon as both front tires are on the pavement, as one motion.
Manual section 2.17.1 Steering to Avoid a Crash

87. **B. Driving too fast for road conditions**
Most bad skids come from too much speed for the conditions. Adjusting speed avoids over-braking and over-steering.
Manual section 2.19 Skid Control and Recovery

88. **C. Up to one second**
Wait for the wheels to roll again before reapplying the brakes, or the vehicle will not straighten out.
Manual section 2.17.2 How to Stop Quickly and Safely

89. **B. Almost always more quickly**
When there is not enough room to stop, steering around the obstacle is often faster, though top-heavy vehicles may tip.
Manual section 2.17.1 Steering to Avoid a Crash

Accidents, fires and alcohol

90. **A. Keep another accident from happening in the same spot**
Protecting the area comes first: move your vehicle aside if you can, turn on flashers and set out triangles.
Manual section 2.20.1 Protect the Area

91. **B. The part that controls judgment and self-control**
Judgment and self-control go first, which is why drinkers often cannot tell they are getting drunk.
Manual section 2.22.1 Alcohol and Driving

92. **A. Keep them shut**
Opening the doors feeds the fire with oxygen and can make it burn very fast, especially with hazardous materials.
Manual section 2.21.3 Fire Fighting

93. **D. Don't open it if you can avoid it**
Turn the engine off and keep the hood closed if possible. Spray through the louvers, radiator or from underneath.
Manual section 2.21.3 Fire Fighting

94. **B. At the source or base of the fire**
Spray the base of the fire, staying as far back as you can and upwind.
Manual section 2.21.3 Fire Fighting

95. **D. In an open area away from buildings, trees, brush and other vehicles**
Get off the road in an open spot where the fire cannot spread. Never pull into a service station.
Manual section 2.21.3 Fire Fighting

96. **D. When the vehicle requires placards**
You may drive a vehicle with hazardous materials that does not need placards. If it needs placards, you need the endorsement.
Manual section 2.23.3 Lists of Regulated Products

97. **B. Apply direct pressure to the wound**
Press directly on the wound to control heavy bleeding, and keep the injured person warm.
Manual section 2.20.3 Care for the Injured

98. **C. Only if fire or passing traffic makes it necessary**
Leave a badly hurt person where they are unless staying put is more dangerous because of fire or traffic.
Manual section 2.20.3 Care for the Injured

99. **C. At least four**
Placards go on the front, the rear and both sides, so others can read them from every direction.
Manual section 2.23.3 Lists of Regulated Products

100. **C. When the doctor says it will not affect safe driving ability**
A prescribed drug is allowed if the doctor tells the driver it will not affect safe driving.
Manual section 2.22.2 Other Drugs

101. **A. A 5-ounce glass of 12% wine**
A 12-ounce 5% beer, a 5-ounce 12% wine and a 1.5-ounce shot of 80 proof liquor all hold the same amount of alcohol.
Manual section 2.22.1 Alcohol and Driving

102. **A. In a pouch on the driver's door or in clear view within reach**
Emergency responders need to find these papers quickly. When you leave the vehicle, they go on the driver's seat.
Manual section 2.23.2 Why Are There Rules?

103. **C. It will spread the flames**
Water spreads burning gasoline. On electrical fires water is also wrong, because of the shock risk.
Manual section 2.21.3 Fire Fighting

Cargo safety

104. **A. Less maximum axle weight**
Bridge formulas lower the weight allowed on closely spaced axles to protect bridges and roads.
Manual section 3.2.2 Legal Weight Limits

105. **A. A flapping cover can tear loose and block your view or someone else's**
A loose cover can uncover the cargo and blow into the view of you or other drivers.
Manual section 3.3.4 Covering Cargo

106. **C. 50 miles**
Re-inspect cargo and tie-downs within the first 50 miles and make any adjustments needed.
Manual section 3.1 Inspecting Cargo

107. **D. Poor traction**
Light drive axles let the drive wheels spin easily, and in bad weather the truck may not be able to keep going.
Manual section 3.2.4 Balance the Weight

108. **D. The loaded weight of a single vehicle as specified by the manufacturer**
GVWR is the manufacturer's figure for how much one vehicle may weigh when loaded.
Manual section 3.2.1 Definitions You Should Know

109. **C. It can be a very unstable load with a high center of gravity**
Suspended meat can swing and raise the center of gravity, so go slowly on off ramps, on ramps and sharp curves.
Manual section 3.4.2 Hanging Meat

110. **B. Your cargo moving forward in a crash or emergency stop**
The header board, or headache rack, should block cargo from sliding forward into the cab.
Manual section 3.3.3 Header Boards

111. C. Put the heaviest parts under the lightest parts

A low center of gravity makes rollover less likely, so heavy items go at the bottom.

Manual section 3.2.3 Don't Be Top-heavy

112. B. False bulkheads to keep the animals bunched together

Animals that can move around shift the load. Even when bunched, they lean on curves, so take extra care.

Manual section 3.4.3 Livestock

113. B. One-half

All the tie-downs together must be rated for at least half the weight of the article or group of articles they secure.

Manual section 3.3.2 Cargo Tie-down

Keep practicing online

This list with a hide-answers switch: https://cdl-testprep.com/cdl-practice-test/general-knowledge/questions-and-answers/
Every CDL practice test: https://cdl-testprep.com/cdl-practice-test/